IN-STORE OPERATIONS · RETAIL

District managers lose hours proving one store is the problem.

Every weekly review requires current-period, prior-period, and district-median OSA comparisons for the store in question.

WHAT THE ROLE IS DOING

- Pulling store availability results for the current and prior equal-length periods from the daily availability mart
- Calculating OSA rates, percentage-point change, and district median comparisons by hand or in ad hoc exports
- Reformatting the numbers into a variance table and narrative before every district scorecard review

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WHY THIS COSTS MORE THAN THE HOURS

The cost is not just analyst time. When the baseline is inconsistent, district managers reach the escalation decision later and risk sending merchandising or inventory teams after the wrong problem.

Not all of this work requires your judgment.

- **EXECUTION 50%** The execution layer retrieves the store and district availability data, computes current-versus-prior OSA rates, evaluates material variance thresholds, and formats the final variance table and direction statement.
- **JUDGMENT 35%** The manager interprets whether the variance reflects a true local store issue, weighs context from store conditions and merchandising plans, and decides what follow-up action to take.
- **STRATEGIC 15%** Strategic decisions such as changing replenishment policy, resetting district OSA expectations, or investing in broader process fixes remain with leadership.

The execution layer is what a Decision Intelligence workflow handles. The judgment and strategic layers remain yours.

What the workflow does — step by step.

1 **Store OSA**

Calculates the focal store's on-shelf availability for the current analysis window and the prior equal-length period.

2 **District Median**

Computes the district median OSA for the same two periods and compares the focal store against that baseline.

Each step queries the warehouse, executes business logic, and passes structured output to the next.

What this workflow does not do.

These decisions belong to the manager.

- It does not decide whether to escalate the store to merchandising or supply chain leadership, determine whether the root cause is replenishment versus shelf execution, adjust staffing or cycle count schedules at the store, approve emergency shipments or overrides, or set the district's OSA target and lost-sales risk thresholds.

The workflow's job is to get you into the meeting already holding a consistent, defensible analysis. What you do with it is yours.

What the output actually looks like.

WORKFLOW OUTPUT — SAMPLE RESPONSE

Store 014 posted 93.5% OSA in the 2026-03-01 to 2026-03-31 window versus a 95.6% district median, a -2.1 percentage point gap that indicates elevated lost-sales risk.

1. **Period-over-period decline** — 50% — Store 014 fell from 95.4% in the prior period to 93.5% in the current period, a -1.9 percentage point deterioration.
2. **Below district baseline** — 35% — The store moved from +0.2 percentage points above district median in the prior period to -2.1 points below it in the current period.
3. **Stable assortment denominator** — 15% — Assortment units remained 15,000 in both periods, so the lower OSA reflects fewer in-stock units rather than assortment changes.

> ► Add Store 014 to the merchandising support queue and review replenishment and shelf execution causes before the next district scorecard meeting.

Generated by the Decision Intelligence workflow against sample data.

Run your own value estimate for district store review work — or talk to us about your in-store operations team.

The Cognitive Labor Value Calculator models team size, role cost, and automation coverage so you can estimate the operational value of removing repetitive analysis work. It takes under two minutes to complete.

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